

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 5♣

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q 10
♥ J 10 9 5 2
♦ J 9 4 3
♣ 5

♠ K 7 6 4

♥ A Q

♦ K Q 8

♣ A J 9 4



♠ J 9 5 2

♥ K 8 7 3

♦ A 7 5 2

♣ 6

♠ 8 3

♥ 6 4

♦ 10 6

♣ K Q 10 8 7 3 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

5 ♣

All Pass

5 ♣ by North

This is **NOT** a simple choice.

Partner may have a hand where 3NT is a laydown.
Or he may have a hand where 3NT is a godown.

Science isn't going to help you so you guess that 5 ♣ probably has a good chance.

South would play 5 ♣.

Click

North plays 5 ♣. East leads ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

North plays 5 ♣. East leads ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

MAYBE West will have the ♠ A and the ♥ K. But maybe not. You do have an extra ♦ trick so you need to determine the best use you can make of that.

First pull trumps. It takes one round. Play your other ♦ winner and discard one of dummy's ♠ s. This protects you from losing more than one ♠. Enter dummy with a trump and lead the last ♠. Assume West has the ♠ A. If he goes up with it you will be able to dump dummy's ♥ loser on your ♠ K. If he plays low you put on your ♠ K and you no longer have a ♠ loser.

If it turns out East has the ♠ A then your ♠ play didn't work. In that case you would enter dummy again and try the ♥ finesse. This plan is a winner if West holds **EITHER** the ♥ K or the ♠ A.

It's always nice to give yourself two chances.

With correct play you succeed when West holds the ♠ A, but also if he holds the ♥ K.

The key play was dumping the ♠ on your ♦ K rather than a ♥.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6 4

♥ 10 5 2

♦ K 8

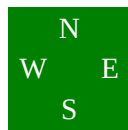
♣ 10 6 4 3

♠ Q J 10 7

♥ J 9 3

♦ A J 4

♣ 9 7 2



♠ A 5

♥ A K Q 7 6 4

♦ Q 7 3

♣ 8 5

♠ 9 3 2

♥ 8

♦ 10 9 6 5 2

♣ A K Q J

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

3♦

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♣A, ♣K, ♣Q.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♣A, ♣K, ♣Q.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

You must eliminate one ♦ loser, that means ruffing it in dummy. You would like to pull trumps first but you cannot chance pulling two rounds because if they don't split 2-2 you would have to leave one out until after you had ruffed the ♦. The problem would then be that the defender who took the ♦ A might lead the third trump, preventing your ruff.

So first you must drive out the ♦ A. After you ruff the ♣ you play a ♦ to dummy's ♦K. North takes the ♦ A and leads a trump. You win in your hand, pull one more trump, then play ♦Q, ♦7, ruffing in dummy. Back to your hand with the ♠A, pull the last trump and claim.

As you see you couldn't afford to pull trumps until after the ♦ ruff.

And you couldn't get the ♦ ruff until after you had forced out the ♦ A.

You have a straightforward 1♥ opening bid.

Partner responds 2♥.

With 17 points and two doubletons you are on the borderline between passing and bidding game. If partner has the top of his 6-10 points you want to be in game, if he is at the bottom you don't.

A reasonable bid would be 3♥, inviting partner to bid game with a maximum.

A better bid is 3♦, a Help Suit Game Try. This says the same thing, bid game with a maximum, but also says "Use your ♦ holding to help you decide."

That was just what West needed. He only had 7 points but decided the ♦ help was worth an extra point or two.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5
♥ K Q J 10 9 2
♦ Q J 4
♣ Q J

♠ A J 4 3

♥ 4

♦ K 7 3 2

♣ A K 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 9

♥ 8 5

♦ 10 9 8 6

♣ 10 8 5 4

♠ K 7 6 2

♥ A 7 6 3

♦ A 5

♣ 9 6 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Dbl	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

it is a suit contract. Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 7

When responding to partner's Takeout Double:- with 0-8 points you bid cheaply- with 9-11 points you jump in a suit- with 12 or more points you cue-bid their suit

You have 11 so you jump to 2 ♠. Partner bids 4 ♠ and you pass.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ K.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ K.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 3? : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5?

The loser count is somewhat misleading because obviously you can ruff some ♥s in dummy.

Sometimes it is better to count winners, even though

Thinking like this makes it clear that you must win 3 of your 4 small trumps. The best way to do this is to win the ♥ A and pull 2 rounds of trumps with ♠ A and ♠ K, spurning the finesse. Trumps split 3-2, so leave the master trump out and cash your other high card winners. Then start cross-ruffing, ♥s in dummy and ♦s in your hand. The defender with the master trump is welcome to ruff with it whenever he wants - it won't stop you from coming to 10 tricks.

You may have been tempted to play the ♠ K, then finesse West for the ♠ Q.

If you tried that East would have won his ♠ Q, then played another ♠. That would leave both you and dummy with only one trump each and you would have come up a trick short. You can afford to pull just two rounds of trumps, then must cross-ruff with your remaining four.